‘track’ of ‘information’ relating to Tata Sons which was an ‘unlisted’ company, the note underlined.

The profits of Tata Sons under Mistry were indeed dismal. The CAGR of the PAT of Tata Sons during the four financial years (2013–14 to 2016–17) of Mistry’s chairmanship revealed a negative growth of close to 31.37 per cent. In comparison, during the first five years of Ratan’s chairmanship, the CAGR in PAT was over 48 per cent and for his entire tenure it was upwards of 27 per cent.

The Tata Sons statement did not discourage Mistry from working to get the boards of the large Tata companies of which he was the chairman to declare support for him. Encouraged by the statement issued earlier by Tata Chemicals, Wadia focused his attention on getting Tata Steel to issue a similar one. He persuaded the independent directors of the company to meet informally in the evening of 10 November. Tata Steel’s eleven-member board comprised of six independent directors.

At this meeting, Wadia distributed the statement issued by the independent directors of Tata Chemicals. Andrew Robb, who was described by Hussain as a remarkably ‘principled’ man, was critical of the role played by Wadia during the meeting. Hussain said that ‘both [Jacobus] Schraven and Robb were not with Cyrus, they were not with Tata. They said that we should do what is right even if it goes against the House of Tatas,’ Hussain added. Robb commented that ‘this statement [of Tata Chemicals] had been orchestrated’ by Wadia and that ‘he was keen that Tata Steel’s independent directors should issue a similar statement’. The meeting could not, however, arrive at a decision on the question of issuing the statement. The next day, before the board meeting, just as he had done in the case of Tata Chemicals, Wadia got the independent directors of Tata Steel to meet in Bombay House. During the meeting, he circulated a revised version of the statement he had shown the directors the previous day. It contained an assertion that the independent directors had unanimously approved the ‘strategy, operations and business of the company’.

But Wadia was unable to persuade all the independent directors to agree to the issuance of the statement. Though there was some consensus on this, subsequently, a view emerged that the statement should be placed before the board.

Together, the meeting of the independent directors and the board meeting took nearly six hours. During the latter, Wadia again attempted to persuade